

Bedtime Tales

Shadow Tag



KIDS BOOK VIDEOS



One sunny afternoon in Willowmere Wood, Noor noticed her shadow — and once she noticed it, she couldn't stop watching it. Step, step, went Noor across the yard. Step, step, went her shadow, right behind her.

Noor's eyes went wide with curiosity. "Hello, shadow," she said.



The shadow did not answer. It just copied her.

Noor waved, and her shadow waved. Noor jumped, and her shadow jumped. A giggle bubbled up inside her.



"You are good at copying," she said. Then she had an idea.

"Let's play tag!"

She ran across the yard, and her shadow ran too. "You can't catch me!" Noor laughed. Joy fizzed through her like lemonade bubbles.



But no matter how fast she ran, her shadow stayed right with her. She zigged, and her shadow zigged. She zagged, and her shadow zagged.

"Tag, tag, tag!" Noor shouted. That was three times she shouted it, and her heart thumped with excitement.



Then Noor tried to lose her shadow. She hid behind the big tree, but her shadow peeked out from behind her. "Found you!" Noor giggled, feeling delightfully silly.

She hid under the table, and her shadow squeezed under too. She hid behind Mama, and her shadow hid behind her shadow. Noor laughed and laughed.



Then the sun began to set, and Noor noticed something. Her shadow was growing long — longer and longer.

"Look how tall I am!" Noor cried, standing up straighter, proud as could be. Her shadow stretched across the whole yard. It touched the fence. It touched the gate.



Then, as the sun dipped lower, the shadow faded. It grew soft, then softer, then it was gone.

"Where did you go?" Noor asked, and a small ache bloomed in her chest.



Mama smiled softly. "Your shadow is sleeping," she said. "It will wake up with the sun."

Noor liked the sound of that. "Goodnight, shadow," she whispered. "Goodnight, goodnight, goodnight." That was three times she whispered it, and her own eyelids were growing heavy too.



That night, Noor dreamed of long, stretchy shadows.



Sleep now, little Noor.

Sleep now, little Noor.

The End

